

Unit 15 Buddhism

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the nature of Buddhism and its effects on the lives of Buddhist believers in the UK. There are four sections covering beliefs and values, community and tradition, worship and celebration, and living the Buddhist life.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.

Detailed unit content

Section 15.1 Beliefs and values

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — anatta, anicca, dukkha, kamma, khandas, magga, nibbana, parinibbana, prajna, samadhi, samsara, Tipitaka

- The meaning and importance of the three marks of existence (anicca, anatta, dukkha).
- The meaning and importance of the Wheel of Existence.
- The meaning and importance of the Four Noble Truths.
- The meaning and importance of the five khandas.
- The main features and importance of the Tipitaka.
- The main features and importance of the Dhammapada.
- The meaning and importance of the way of wisdom (prajna).
- The meaning and importance of the way of morality (sila).
- The meaning and importance of the way of meditation (samadhi).
- The nature and importance of the sangha.
- The relationship between lay people and the sangha.